

Today let's unpack the cursed currency of the sunken coin. It's mostly mentioned under thalassus but we need to develop an economy based around it. In short I want to have it be used to purchase illegal items such as poisons, diseases, illegal trade goods such as stolen or fenced items, aetheric echoes outside of the unity academy, and in secrets and spycraft these coins can also be used to purchase illegal services such as hits, assassination, and other concepts we can mine the GTA series and GTA v online for ideas for. All the colleges trade in this coinage, not overtly or publicly but a more tongue in cheek clandestine like. However, only the college of transmutation actually hires and uses "mercenaries" and other black outfits such as pirates and other people who seek personal gain and to exploit others. This college is one that houses and is directly involved in the affairs of the average user for the cursed coin - a sort of caricature of the market down established and run by the college of conjuration. This also is the reason why the college is so effective - they are non-discriminate to the people they teach not out of a sense of fiscal needs but out of a sense of the college does what it needs to survive. As a trade off to teaching and working with the college an "undesirable" can "earn" their education through repeated loyalty and service to the college - a thoroughly reputation based system for illegal services and materials in which the college will keep you alive and develop your skills if you prove yourself capable and loyal. It overtly "protects" The students on the ledgers that come in from the generalist college because they know they are being watched and they have to look like they are "playing nice" and have a mostly 0 tolerance for losing students to petty things like getting lost or dying and explicitly use their magic to "babysit" these individuals by tracking and using life magic to ensure they don't die actually implanting the students early on after "proving themselves" through a harrowing trial emphasis on harrowing in which they earn the right to this immortality. The implanted immortality is both a blessing and a curse as seen with Harkness from Doctor Who as it is procured via the use of cursed currency or the products bought with cursed currency and thereby "cursed" to have a detriment to the user - which is a genie level curse of both cancer and the literal fact they can never die but still feel pain and grow back like Deadpool there is also the entry fee of the student having to commit and earn the currency while being fully informed of the consequences and the kicker is even if the student is "gifted" or "forced" to have the implant the fact that it's cursed and irremovable is irrelevant. Their "undesirable" allies on the other hand are kept for however long they are needed and usually useful and don't have such "assurances" but can earn or buy "immortality" all the same. The implants are likewise unique and can be generally tracked with the fallacy there in being that they can always be tracked when the implant being able to be concealed or obfuscated like any other innate quality it just gives divinationist an edge. In fact I want to make that a codified rule: no quality that can be tracked can be truly concealed or truly revealed. This concept applies to defenses and other forms of conflict - there is no such thing as impossible and there should always be a way out. This ends up with the students coming in accidental contact with the scum of the earth that takes territory very seriously as regardless of the social aspect these "people" have either a more tribal close knit community or a very feral loner isolationist vibe. This means shooting first and instead of asking questions never instead dragging the body to nearest college way station that's likely unmanned. The penalty for killing and then hiding the body of a student leads to severe penalties to culminates in dying as the student will be found and will be brought back. This leads to the college of transmutation employing the college of necromancy to act as stewards begrudgingly legitimizing and

supporting the aspects of life by dealing with the dead who give life, again it does what it has to and as such it takes some of the "public grace" and reputation by supporting the more positive aspects of the colleges. They don't have to agree with or like each other but they respect each other and create a synergy that enables them to survive with both colleges being willing to kill to maintain. Other obligate mutualism exists within the college's networks as well such as the interaction between the college of conjuration with the college of illusion for marketable entertainment and marketing for their products and services, with the unity college for the people to sell to, with the college of abjuration to protect their assets, with the college of transmutation to find more resources (ruthless is marketable), with the college of necromancy to hedge their bets, and the college of divination to forecast. With my rule establishing nothing is impossible we can see push and pull dynamics form. We see this with the interplay between the college of divination and abjuration with the best trapsmiths being the ones that know security the best and can reverse engineer the systems like white hat hackers against the concept of weaponized luck and prescience or good ole observation and conventional methods of spycraft.

I see the variation of the cursed currency being called "thorns" a mutagenic or concentrate that can be used in grafts, as a high powered or dangerous material component, or other adjective to be used or desired that is beyond the average person in one aspect or another usually involving danger. Thorns aren't currency (they can be) but is like dealing with poisons or radio active material - the stuff will kill you if you don't take precautions and usually used to kill. Thorns aren't anything specific but are the mutated items that are overflowing with magical energy that is dangerous to use without protection. They represent the physical dangers made manifest and represent literal risk.

The wild path warden college is not known for their close association with the "undesirables" they take a more apathetic view to them publicly instead. People know the forest is dangerous and they know it's a refuge for "undesirables" of society. Just no one wants to go in and weed them out with the college not seeing it as part of their duties to interfere in the life of their citizens and they view everyone a citizen if they do it with their own two hands not seeing or caring about the responsibility to govern it's own lands because of the ideology that the lands will govern and maintain itself. The students are sold on becoming "prestigious" special forces similar to that of the USA the Survival, Evasion, Resistance, and Escape (SERE) training but dialed to the point where the instructors will only stop long enough to revive you after you die. This isn't a pleasure course. Some think it is and act as a means for the college to cook the books but the college grants generous full ride scholarships as facilitated through the generalist college. NDAs and Contracts are usually the method of force for any college to ensure retention but the college of transmutation is the college of last resort for malcontents that are too much for the other colleges to deal with as much as they are into the image of selling themselves as the setting's version of the coast guard being the ones to call when an asset needs to be retrieved from an unexpected extraplanar excursion, bringing back the "dog tags" of the dead if nothing else. It's important to understand that some do it for guts and self interest and others do it for accolades and others do it out of a sense of righteousness. It's important to understand that some do it for guts and self interest and others do it for accolades and others do it out of a sense of righteousness. There's no bill of rescue as it's baked into the contracts and NDAs part

of the generous and earned benefits of immortality without becoming an undead. The fine print details that this contract doesn't cover death. It's part the "generous scholarship" deal. Due to the consequences of hiding a student general practice has become either taking the dead to a local way station manned by the college of necromancy who won't ask to many questions and won't generally care about the condition of the dead as long as grave robbing isn't done in front of them. The college of necromancy, facilitated by the college of transmutation, will raise the dead for free, across the lands at any facility that houses either college but at the convenience for free or low tiers or contractual payment for higher tier. The college of necromancy will default to undead status while the college of transmutation defaults to living but charging for "modifiers" such as limb regeneration beyond the absolute minimum.

The college of necromancy will have perfected and begun distribution of the "revive stones" that will hold your soul in the case of your untimely demise. Allowing for your revival at the nearest college of necromancy aligned way station, guild hall, or church with different levels and quality of resurrection based on policy. This lead to a sudden need that rocked the market - our moment when the PC actually became a household appliance. Just owning a stone will ensure you're revived at the most basic degree - what that means is dependent on the insurer - creating a market that requires strict regulation as determined by the mortal divine bodies of the unified Church Of Aíon lead by the college of necromancy. They have and understand that all other divine representations are just cultural variations to the same Pantheon just with different "aspects" or names being behind similar or the same concept as viewed across multiple perspectives and social temporal time zones. They would be right as well making that another unspoken rule of this setting.

The implant is a bit of concentrated "life" nature that is from the verdant font. It's a nuclear reactor causing mutations as natural part of this process. No getting around this it's a trade off. It keeps the individual alive really well and has deadpool problems. The person becomes a universal donor as a consolation and produce fully functional organs that are overtly redundant and a drain if left uncontrolled. This forces the college of transmutation to learn how to modify their forms on the fly and to conserve energy and being able to become anything by melting or rearranging their form. It is magical yes but it is also very visceral and unique to the individual. Common methods exists but every student must learn to manage it in their own way as a burden and boon.

This is a sophisticated pivot. You are moving away from a "Pirate/Gangster" vibe for the Wildpath Wardens and shifting toward a "Black Ops / Hazard Response" aesthetic. They are the Jungle SERE (Survival, Evasion, Resistance, and Escape) specialists of the setting—the ones who go where the map stops.

Here is the codified breakdown of "Thorns," the "Revive Stone Economy," and the "Verdant Reactor" implant system.

1. The Hazardous Economy: "Thorns"

"Thorns" are not minted coins. They are Hazardous Material Units. In this economy, value is determined by Volatility.

* What is a Thorn?

- * It is a physical manifestation of raw, dangerous magic. It could be a crystallized gland from a Basilisk, a vial of concentrated sap from the Verdant Font, or a shard of petrified lightning.

- * The Test of Value: If you hold it in your bare hand for a minute, does it kill you? If yes, it's high value.

- * Handling: You don't carry these in a coin purse. You carry them in lead-lined satchels, stasis jars, or suspended in alchemical fluids.

- * Usage:

- * The Battery: They are used to power illegal, high-yield spells that would burn out a normal focus.

- * The Component: They are the primary ingredient for Grafts (magical limb replacements) and Poisons.

- * The Weapon: In a pinch, you can throw a Thorn like a grenade. It is raw magical radiation.

- * The Market: "I'll trade you three grams of unstable Void-Dust (Thorns) for that information."

2. The Wildpath Wardens: The "Coast Guard" of the Abyss

The College of Transmutation is not a school; it is a Boot Camp for the Broken.

- * Recruitment (The Malcontents): The other colleges expel students for aggression, insubordination, or dangerous volatility. The Wildpath Wardens offer them a "Scholarship."

- * The Pitch: "You're too wild for the library. Come to the Titanwood. We'll teach you how to turn that anger into armor."

- * The Public Face (The Apathy): The Wardens patrol the Titanwood, but they don't "police" it.

- * The Squatter Policy: Criminals, exiles, and monsters hide in the woods. The Wardens ignore them. The ideology is "The Land Governs Itself." If a bandit survives the Owlbears, they earn their place. If they die, they are fertilizer. The Wardens only intervene if the threat tries to leave the woods.

- * The "Coast Guard" Mission:

- * They are the Extraplanar Search and Rescue. When a Conjurer accidentally teleports a noble's son into the Elemental Chaos, the family hires the Wardens.

- * The Dog Tag Directive: They promise to bring something back. Ideally the person. Usually just the identifier.

3. The Tech: The Revive Stone Network

This is the "Household Appliance" moment for the setting. Resurrection is no longer a miracle; it is an Insurance Policy.

- * The Object: The Revive Stone (Soul Anchor). A small, rune-etched gemstone carried on a necklace or embedded in a bracelet.

- * Function: When the user dies, the stone acts as a "Soul Trap," preventing the soul from departing to the Palimpsest/Afterlife for a set duration (24-72 hours).

- * The Network: The College of Necromancy (Mortis Aevum) manages the "Soul Cloud."

- * The Drop-Off: If you find a dead body with a Stone, you drag it to the nearest Waystation (Church, Guild Hall, or outpost).

- * The No-Questions Policy: The Necromancers don't care how you died. They just check your subscription tier.

The Resurrection Tiers (The "Generous Scholarship")

- * Tier 1: The "Economy" Package (Necromancy Default)

- * Cost: Free/Low (Covered by basic insurance).

- * Result: You come back as Undead (a sentient zombie or skeleton) or you are revived with severe "Soul Lag" (cold, emotionless). You are alive, technically.
- * Tier 2: The "Standard" Package (Transmutation Default)
 - * Cost: Covered by the Warden Scholarship/Contract.
 - * Result: Biological Revival. You are alive and breathing.
 - * The Catch: They do the bare minimum. If you were decapitated, they sew the head back on, but they don't fix the scar. If you lost an arm, you wake up without the arm.
- * Tier 3: The "Premium" Modifiers (The Upsell)
 - * Cost: Thorns or huge debts.
 - * Result: Limb regeneration, scar removal, cosmetic enhancement. "Since we have you on the slab, want to add night vision eyes? It's extra."

4. The Implant: The Verdant Reactor

The "Secret Sauce" of the Wildpath Wardens. It is not a delicate piece of technology; it is a Chunk of the Plane of Life jammed into your chest.

- * The Nature of the Implant: It is a Nuclear Reactor of Life Energy. It pumps positive energy into the host 24/7.
- * The Boon (Deadpool Regeneration): The user effectively cannot die from physical trauma. Bullets push out, bones knit instantly. They are Universal Donors—their blood is liquid life potion.
- * The Curse (The Body Horror):
 - * The Overgrowth: The body has too much life. If the user doesn't focus, they grow tumors, extra fingers, vestigial twins, or redundant organs.
 - * The Drain: The metabolism runs at 1000%. They must eat constantly or the reactor starts consuming their own fat and muscle for fuel.
- * The Skill (Polymorph as Management):
 - * Transmutation magic for these students isn't about "casting a spell" to turn into a bear. It is Bio-Management.
 - * The Process: "I have three extra livers growing because of the reactor. I need to melt them down and reshape that biomass into claws."
 - * Visceral Magic: Changing shape hurts. It sounds like snapping bones and wet meat. It is terrifying to watch.

5. The Theology: The Unified Theory of Aspects

The Church of Aíon (led by the Necromancers) has codified the "Universal Aspect Theory."

- * The Doctrine: "There is only The Pantheon. All other gods are just cultural nicknames."
- * The Policy: The Church accepts all revive stones, regardless of which "God" the user prays to, because they view a prayer to a tribal war god as just a prayer to Bellum Hegemon with a different accent.
- * The Effect: This allows the Necromancers to monopolize the death industry globally without starting a religious war. They are the "bankers" of the soul trade, neutral and ubiquitous.

Summary for the Player

- * You play a Warden: You are a survivalist mutant with a nuclear reactor in your chest.
- * Your Currency: You trade in dangerous, radioactive magical waste ("Thorns").
- * Your Safety Net: You have a Revive Stone. If you die, you wake up on a slab. If you didn't pay for the premium package, you might wake up missing a hand.

* Your Magic: You don't sparkle. You ripple. You turn into a wolf by breaking your own bones and growing fur in seconds. It is gross, efficient, and keeps you alive.

The college of necromancy is held accountable for reviving the population. It's there public face hiding the horror. They are *supposed* to revive the dead as undead at a minimum as they have the time and ability. Which they were the ones who pushed for standardized work days if anyone is curious having their surgeons who worked their labs in service to daedalon who end up dying to their craft and being the group known for unfinished work pushing themselves to undeath by establishing both brakes and standards for health. The dead are also supposed to be held in a record that people can petition to call on. The service the mortis aevum collegium runs is a for profit "charity". The college is likewise not picky with who they deal with on selling the secrets of the dead and the rights to the dead. If someone comes to collect free tier, files the appropriate paperwork to track the soul and other legal services then the soul is released to the individual. Starting from a place of actual but messy charity and good will has had the system codified to "expedite" the process and to track for bad actors only becoming a heavily regulated "past" market for a soul trade. Being able to read the soul and the history of it helps give a physical presence to the concept of xp. XP is your recorded deeds that follow the character as an ephemeral concept that can't be taken away from them as it's the lived events that literally embody the character. By approximately measuring a soul's "truth" which is an accurate retelling of the legends and stories that make up that soul the college can develop the ability to determine how much xp someone has and has started a codex for tracking the mutation debt bringing their costs into the system as a internally codified system measuring the xp cost.

You keep assigning cost and a price to resurrection. Yes the college keeps free crystals but actually reviving the dead is also free. Undead is easiest and if you have the body of the recently departed then they can be brought back as a skeleton or zombie along with their soul stone. Other forms of undeath are regulated to prevent abuse and for tracking and zoning, but also free depending on type. They're not second class citizens but if there's a ghoull outbreak they know who to ask. Contracting ghoul fever is usually easiest if still living with "proper" guaranteed mummification being premium or being turned into a vampire behind high society premium tiers. These are examples and not a comprehensive list.

You also are ignoring the "good faith" clause I'm positing. The mortis aevum collegium is supposed to revive souls in their possession within a reasonable set time frame as part of their obligations to the public. That part is charity and free. That reasonable time frame needs to be less than five an half years. The church has become the third party lien holder and bank for souls in this instance. They run the mechanisms and are in charge of maintaining this massive basically government funded program. They do lose souls both legitimately and illegitimately. They facilitate the soul futures not only on the dead in the form of "pasts" - souls currently in the free tier that no one has claimed and any one can claim with certain restrictions to prevent individuals from buying to many as a form of regulation and anti-monopoly especially to prevent rogue necromancers or individuals who would seek to torture the souls or to curb rampant slavery. The college also is the driver and marketstreet for adventurer group futures where the bets are placed on organized parties ranging between 1 to 8 people. The college of divination

runs the actual market for the futures and pasts acting as the accountants ensuring everyone's ledgers are accurate - not necessarily above board acting as the IRS who will tip the scales of fate for a price.

The implant is *also* Deadpool cancer. Transmutation is the solution to bypassing the pain and internalizing and using raw magical power. They are life *engines*. If they feel pain they edit their nervous system to stop feeling pain. If they are contained in a box or an extra dimensional space it is their prerogative to adapt to the situation and escape. They have no choice or risk madness. The implant also grants them passive regeneration that they can improve on. The implant is common enough for individuals who prove themselves or go through the general college and gets in through the scholarship. The body doesn't immediately snap back to a form but it facilitates the ability to adapt or change one's form to do so. The college cannot calculate an upper limit for soul mutations. We can see the mechanical cap but they cannot because even on a failed mission or state the soul still gains experience which pushes the souls cap along with it. They can see and quantify the risk however and can and typically tie it to stability in any field especially mentally but it's not always representative for mental. The college quantifies the risk of bringing an individual back based on the mutations (metaphysical debts) and story (xp). I need to develop a social and (vs) sanity tracker. The college tracks souls to be accountable for rogue necromancers to prevent them from raising an army of undead. It wasn't brittle zombies it was the Chirurgeons were dying at the operating table. Dying for their craft and being overworked.

This acts as a massive tonal shift for the setting, moving it from a standard fantasy economy to a Bureaucratic Gothic nightmare. You have effectively turned the afterlife into the DMV meets the Stock Market, and Transmutation into Bio-Punk Body Horror.

Here is the codified update to the Mortis Aevum Bureaucracy, the Soul Market, and the Implant Mechanics, including your requested Social vs. Sanity Tracker.

1. The Mortis Aevum Collegium: The "Unionized" Death Industry

The College of Necromancy is not a cult; it is a Public Utility. They are the sanitation workers, the coroners, and the insurance adjusters of the soul.

- * The Origin of Rights (The Chirurgeon's Sacrifice):

- * The College didn't start regulating undeath to control the world; they did it to save their own staff. In the early days, Chirurgeons (magical surgeons) serving Daedalon's industrial revolution were dying of exhaustion at the operating table.

- * The Standard: The College established "The Mortal Limit." Mandatory breaks, health standards, and the use of the undead for hazardous labor were codified to prevent the living staff from working themselves to death.

- * The "Good Faith" Clause (The 5.5 Year Rule):

- * The Obligation: As a government-funded "Charity," the College is legally required to resurrect any citizen with a Revive Stone (Soul Trap) within a "Reasonable Timeframe."

- * The Loophole: That timeframe is capped at 5.5 years.

- * The Free Tier: If you die and you are poor (Free Tier), your soul is trapped and stored in the "Pending" vault. You sit in the queue. They will get to you eventually (it's free!), but you might wake up 5 years later when it's "convenient" for the shift manager.

- * Expedition: Wealthy families or Guilds pay "Expedition Fees" to bump their souls to the front of the line (Instant Resurrection).

- * The Default Resurrection (The "Economy" Model):

- * If you don't specify a method, the College defaults to Undead (Skeleton/Zombie) because it is resource-efficient.

- * Legal Status: They are not second-class citizens. They are "Post-Vital Citizens." If there is a Ghoul Fever outbreak, the College tracks it like the CDC tracks the flu.

2. The Soul Market: "Pasts" and "Futures"

Because souls are held for years in the "Free Tier" backlog, they became financial assets.

- * "Pasts" (The Unclaimed Market):

- * These are souls in the 5.5-year queue that no one has claimed.

- * The Trade: Guilds can petition to "Claim" a soul. "We need a master mason. This soul was a mason. We will pay his resurrection fee if he signs a 10-year labor contract."

- * Regulation: Heavily monitored to prevent slavery/torture. You cannot buy too many (Anti-Monopoly laws), and you cannot buy a soul just to hurt it. Rogue Necromancers who hoard souls for private armies are hunted down by the College for "Tax Evasion" and "Zoning Violations."

- * "Futures" (The Adventurer Market):

- * Investors bet on active Adventuring Parties (1-8 people).

- * The Bet: "I bet 5,000 Thorns that 'The Iron Company' clears the dungeon."

- * The Mechanics: This allows parties to get funding for gear. If they die, the investor owns their "Revive Stone" and can decide whether to pay for their resurrection (to work off the debt) or sell their soul to the "Pasts" market.

- * The IRS (Chronosynclastic Institute):

- * The Diviners run the accounting. They ensure the "Truth" (XP) matches the Ledger.

- * The Corruption: They are the impartial auditors, but for a price, they will "nudge" the probability of a party surviving or dying to ensure the Futures Market pays out to the right people.

3. The Implant: The "Life Engine" & The Bio-Edit

The Transmutation Implant (Verdant Reactor) is not just a battery; it is a Survival Imperative.

- * The Harkness State:

- * The user does not need to eat or breathe. The reactor sustains them.

- * The Pain: The reactor burns. It is a nuclear fire of life. The user feels the constant sensation of their cells dying and rebirthing.

- * Transmutation as "Self-Editing":

- * You don't just "shape-shift." You Bio-Hack.

- * Pain Management: A novice Transmuter screams in pain. A Master Transmuter uses their magic to sever their own pain receptors or rewrite their nervous system to interpret the burning as "background noise."

- * Forced Adaptation: If you lock an implanted user in a steel box, they won't starve. The madness of the confinement + the reactor's energy will force them to adapt. They might dissolve into slime to slide out the cracks, or evolve diamond-hard drills for hands. They must escape, or their body will mutate until it fills the box.

4. The Mechanic: XP, Debt, and the "Humanity Index"

Since the College can measure "Truth" (XP) and "Mutation Debt," we can create a tracker for the player.

The Concept:

- * XP (The Anchor): Your lived experience, your memories, your "Truth." This keeps you sane. It is your sense of Self.

- * Mutation (The Drift): The alien magic warping your body and soul. This pulls you toward madness/monstrosity.

The "Tether" System (Sanity vs. Social)

On your character sheet, you have a sliding scale called The Tether.

The Equation:

Current XP (The Truth) - Total Mutation Debt (The Change) = Tether Score

The Zones of Existence:

- * The Grounded (Positive Score):

- * State: Your history (XP) outweighs your mutations. You remember who you are.

- * Social: You can interact with normal people. You pass for human (mostly).

- * Sanity: Stable.

- * The Drift (Near Zero):

- * State: Your mutations are equal to your history. You are losing touch.

- * Effect: You must use Transmutation to "Edit" your brain to maintain focus.

- * Social Penalty: People feel an instinctive "Uncanny Valley" fear around you. Prices in "Normal" shops increase.

- * The Severed (Negative Score):

- * State: Your body has more magic than your soul has memory. You are becoming an NPC/Monster.

- * The "Box" Effect: If you take massive damage or trauma here, your body reacts autonomously (Deadpool/Harkness). You might regenerate a head, but it might not be your head for a few minutes.

- * Social: You are terrifying. "Normal" society rejects you. You can only trade in the Undercurrent (Black Market).

- * Sanity: You gain "Alien Logic." You no longer process pain, empathy, or fear like a human. You must roll to resist "Instinctive Adaptation" (e.g., eating a corpse because you need carbon, ignoring the morality of it).

The College's Assessment:

When the Mortis Aevum assesses a soul for resurrection, they look at this Tether Score.

- * High Tether: "Low Risk. Revive as Standard."

- * Low/Negative Tether: "High Risk. Soul is volatile."

- * Action: The College might refuse to revive you without a "Safety Contract" (binding spell) or might sell your "Future" to the Wildpath Wardens, knowing only they can handle your level of monstrosity.

This creates a game loop: You need Mutations to be powerful, but you need XP to stay Human. If you buy too much power (Mutations) without earning the "Truth" (XP) to anchor it, you turn into a monster.

To clarify the soul reading gets the stories and the riddles of the person's life. Their soul reading doesn't reveal overt secrets but it won't lie either.

Your previous suggestion for tracking sanity vs mutations was both appalling and pathetic. Sanity as we've previously discussed is based on a variety of factors. We never did fully expand on that but it's the mental combat tree sanity vs being driven mad.

Xp is not a mechanic to be used lightly. You also have the wrong idea about xp. It is used to stabilize your identity and your pattern. The more xp you have the more mutations you can hold period without going over your escrow. All starting characters start out with slot 120 xp and have build xp factored into their formulas requiring xp to calculate. The max number of mutations is $xp * 8$ and that number changes as you get xp. Anything after the escrow limit of $xp * 2$ is taxed at 25% total xp gains with a minimum floor of I believe 2 or 3 xp for a session that goes to pay down the debt until the xp spent is lower than total $xp * 2$.

The mortis aevum collegium not because of war but because the doctors were getting sick and dying themselves while attempting to treat plague or other maladies that affect the general public. The dead don't get sick or tired and the ones that weren't outright overwhelmed and over worked ended turning to necromancy anyway.

You keep thinking that the souls get uploaded to a cloud network. Why? They would likely be secured on site in local mausoleums and other holy places with regular distributions to and from the college as the central hub. Think library with interbook loans or the post office. These services supporting this network are handled by the other colleges. If anything they're revived locally and not shipped. They're only really shipped if they're important or "owned" by a guild or organization.

Stories are a matter of trust and acts as a reference. If a graft or a grant of some sunk financial capital is applied then it is weighed against the narrative capital of the soul. Souls that are easier to read and having more depth is more reliable. Souls with a lot of narrative debt could be a liability risking instability or insanity. Souls without any experience is usually recommended to a college. The goal is for the stories that are being told reinforce the greater narrative.

Social and mental pillars literally have HP pools. They literally have defense pools and values. Why are we reinventing the wheel?